

# Annual Performance Self-Assessment

Stephanie Wells, Senior Product Manager, Growth and Analytics Pod

|               |                                    |
|---------------|------------------------------------|
| Employee      | Stephanie Wells                    |
| Role          | Senior Product Manager             |
| Manager       | Carlos Rivera, Director of Product |
| Review date   | November 25, 2026                  |
| Review period | January 2026 to November 2026      |
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## 1. Summary of Contributions

This has been the most concentrated year of my career at Vantage Loop. The Northstar project moved from a blank doc to a production-ready dashboard in roughly 13 months, shipped to general availability on November 13, 2026, on time following a schedule revision in February 2026. I was promoted to Senior Product Manager in January 2026 and took on full ownership of the Growth and Analytics pod alongside the Northstar launch. I also ran the pilot program, managed three enterprise accounts through the beta period, and maintained the mentoring program despite a compressed personal schedule.

## 2. Goal Review: 2026 Targets vs. Actuals

| Goal                     | Target            | Actual                                | Assessment |
|--------------------------|-------------------|---------------------------------------|------------|
| Ship Northstar to GA     | November 13, 2026 | November 13, 2026 (on time)           | Met        |
| Pilot NPS at ship        | 8 or higher       | 9.3 average across 3 pilots           | Exceeded   |
| 30-day pilot retention   | 40 percent        | 41.2 percent (the analytics platform) | Met        |
| Support ticket reduction | 30 percent        | 34 percent (the support platform Q4)  | Exceeded   |
| Mentoring sessions       | 24 sessions/year  | 22 sessions (2 missed for wedding)    | Near miss  |
| Roth IRA contribution    | Max (\$7,000)     | Maxed Feb 2026                        | Met        |

### 3. Competency Ratings

| Competency                     | Self-Rating (1-5) | Evidence                                                                                             |
|--------------------------------|-------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Strategic thinking             | 4                 | Northstar roadmap built from churn signal, not feature requests. Deferred 4 post-launch items.       |
| Cross-functional collaboration | 4                 | Daily alignment with Megan Shaw (eng), Tomoko Hayashi (design), Ryan Iyer (data). Zero blockers.     |
| Customer focus                 | 5                 | Ran 4 pilot feedback cycles; every NS-F00x decision traced to specific customer request.             |
| Data-driven decision making    | 4                 | Used the analytics platform as source of truth; cross-checked the secondary analytics platform.      |
| Execution and delivery         | 4                 | Northstar shipped on target after February reschedule. No critical post-launch bugs in first sprint. |
| Communication                  | 4                 | PRD v3.1 kept current through feature freeze; weekly status posted to team chat #northstar.          |
| Mentoring and sponsorship      | 4                 | 22 of 24 planned sessions completed; two early-career PMs moved into stretch projects.               |

### 4. What Went Well

The decision to run a structured beta with defined pilot accounts rather than a broad soft launch was the right call. Pilot feedback directly shaped the feature priority (X12.xlsx RICE scores) and gave us three NPS-ready advocates at GA. The close working relationship with Megan Shaw meant engineering surprises were surfaced early; no sprint was blocked by a PM decision for more than 24 hours. The February ship date revision, though painful, was made early enough that we landed on November 13 with confidence rather than panic.

### 5. What I Would Do Differently

The Q3 planning cycle (which landed in the quiet lull of my personal calendar) created a sprint execution gap that put S13 under pressure. In future, I would build a clearer deputy arrangement with Megan so that PM coverage is seamless during planned absences. I also underinvested in the load-testing conversation before S13; the performance issue on large cohorts (ENT-PC-002 pain point) surfaced later than it should have. A formal non-functional requirements review at project kickoff would have caught this in October 2025.

### 6. Development Goals for 2027

- Move into scoping and early execution on the API access feature (NS-F011) as a stepping stone toward technical PM depth.
- Present at one external product conference in 2027 (SF Product Meetup or ProductCon).
- Complete a formal mentoring cohort rather than ad-hoc sessions.
- Evaluate the VP of Product track within Vantage Loop or externally; schedule a conversation with Victor Ross by Q1 2027.

## 7. Personal Context Note

October 2026 was unusually compressed: the Northstar feature freeze (October 9), Castle Rock trip (October 10), annual physical (October 15), my father's neurology appointment (October 16), the wedding (October 17), and the Ridgeline Bouldering Competition (October 24) all landed in a 15-day window. I am grateful for the team's support and for Carlos's flexibility in holding the feature freeze date rather than pulling it forward under pilot pressure.

My father's Parkinson's progression is an ongoing personal priority. I expect to need more flexibility in Q1 2027 as my parents assess home modifications and PT adjustments. I will flag schedule needs proactively rather than absorbing them silently.

## 8. Appendix: Key References

|                  |                                    |
|------------------|------------------------------------|
| PRD              | P01.pdf, version 3.1               |
| Sprint log       | X02.xlsx, sprints S12 through S14  |
| Pilot feedback   | X07.xlsx, cycles 1 through 4       |
| RICE backlog     | X12.xlsx                           |
| Launch readiness | P09.pdf                            |
| Finance summary  | X06.xlsx                           |
| Care log (Dad)   | D06.docx (private family document) |

## Appendix A: Competency Matrix and Development Goals

### Self-Assessment Ratings vs Manager Calibration

| Competency                  | Self-Rating (1-5) | Manager Rating | Target Q4 |
|-----------------------------|-------------------|----------------|-----------|
| Strategic Roadmapping       | 4                 | 4              | 5         |
| Stakeholder Communication   | 4                 | 4              | 5         |
| Data-Driven Prioritization  | 5                 | 5              | 5         |
| Cross-Functional Leadership | 3                 | 4              | 4         |
| Technical Depth             | 3                 | 3              | 4         |
| OKR Alignment               | 4                 | 4              | 5         |
| Delivery and Execution      | 5                 | 5              | 5         |
| Mentoring Junior PMs        | 3                 | 3              | 4         |

### Q4 2026 Development Action Plan

| Q4 Development Goal                                    | Owner             | Due        |
|--------------------------------------------------------|-------------------|------------|
| Complete advanced stakeholder workshop series          | S. Wells          | 2026-11-30 |
| Shadow VP-level roadmap review for Northstar launch    | S. Wells / B. Kim | 2026-11-15 |
| Lead one recruiting loop for PM Analyst role           | S. Wells          | 2026-12-01 |
| Publish internal blog post on RICE framework learnings | S. Wells          | 2026-10-31 |

Notes: Ratings based on Vantage Loop PM ladder v2.3. Final calibration to be confirmed in Nov 2026 review cycle. See P01.pdf for project context and D04.docx for full promotion case.